SERVICENOW

Streamlining IT Procurement

Automating Standard Laptop Orders with Flow Designer

Team ID: SWTID-2026-1951

Based on stakeholder interviews and observations from the IT Procurement Automation team

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SCENARIO

Requesting, approving, fulfilling, and tracking a standard laptop order

	Entice	Enter	Engage	Exit	Extend
	How does someone initially become aware of this process?	What do people experience as they begin the process?	In the core moments in the process, what happens?	What do people typically experience as the process finishes?	What happens after the experience is over?
Steps What does the person (or group) typically experience?	**Need identified** A new hire, replacement, or hardware refresh creates the need for a standard laptop	**Visit service portal** The requester opens the ServiceNow Service Portal on the web or mobile app	**Browse catalog** They search the Hardware category of the Service Catalog for laptops	**Compare models** They review the approved standard laptop models and their specs	**View item details** They open a catalog item to see specs, cost, and estimated delivery time	**Start request** After choosing a model, they click Order Now on the catalog item	**Complete request form** They fill in the model, justification, cost center, and delivery location	**Submit request** They review the summary and submit; a request (REQ) and item (RITM) are created	**Email confirmation** An email immediately confirms the request number and what happens next	**Flow triggered** Flow Designer detects the new request item and starts the automation	**Validate & approve** The flow checks the model is standard and within budget, then auto-approves or routes to the manager	**Create fulfillment tasks** Catalog tasks are created and assigned to procurement and the asset team	**Order & deliver** The vendor order is placed, the device is received, imaged, and shipped to the user	**Close tasks** Fulfillment tasks are completed and the request item is closed automatically	**Notify requester** An email and portal notification confirm delivery and setup details	**Submit feedback** The requester rates the experience in a short satisfaction survey	**Asset record updated** The laptop is added to the asset record and assigned to the user	**Reporting & analytics** Request volume, cycle time, and cost data feed dashboards	**Flow optimization** The team reviews flow execution history to find errors and delays	**Expand automation** The flow pattern is reused for other standard items such as monitors and phones
Interactions What interactions do they have at each step along the way? ■ **People:** Who do they see or talk to? ■ **Places:** Where are they? ■ **Things:** What digital touchpoints or physical objects would they use?	Email or message from the manager; HR onboarding ticket	Service Portal on the website or ServiceNow Mobile app	Hardware category of the Service Catalog in the Service Portal	Catalog item pages in the Service Portal	Catalog item page in the Service Portal Pricing and availability come from the approved vendor catalog and stock records.	Catalog item page (Order Now button)	Catalog item form and variables in the Service Portal	Order summary screen within the Service Portal	Requester's email (software like Outlook or website like Gmail)	Flow Designer trigger runs in the background; the requester takes no action	Flow Designer approval action; manager's email or approval inbox The approver sees a clear summary of requester, model, and cost.	Catalog tasks in the ServiceNow Agent Workspace	Procurement staff, vendor portal, and shipping courier Devices are imaged and tagged before delivery to the requester.	Flow Designer execution; ServiceNow request records	Requester's email and Service Portal notifications	Survey in the Service Portal or email link	Asset Management and CMDB modules	Performance Analytics dashboards and reports	Flow Designer executions and flow reporting	Flow Designer and Service Catalog configuration
Goals & motivations At each step, what is a person's primary goal or motivation? ("Help me..." or "Help me avoid...")	Help me get a laptop without a long wait	Help me find the right place to order	Help me find a laptop that fits my role	Help me see what the approved options offer	Help me understand the specs, cost, and delivery time	Help me commit to this standard laptop	Help me fill out the form quickly and correctly	Help me feel confident my request is submitted	Help me know what happens next	Help me skip manual hand-offs and delays	Help me get quick approval without chasing people	Help me make sure no task is missed or misrouted	Help me get my laptop ready on time	Help me avoid manual closure and paperwork	Help me know my laptop is ready and how to start	Help me share feedback about the process	Help me keep an accurate record of every asset	Help me see trends in cost and cycle time	Help me find and fix flow errors fast	Help me automate more standard requests
Positive moments What steps does a typical person find enjoyable, productive, fun, motivating, delightful, or exciting?			A single catalog makes it easy to find standard laptop models		Clear specs and fixed pricing remove guesswork			A request number is generated instantly	Instant confirmation email builds confidence		Standard requests within budget are auto-approved in minutes	Tasks are created and assigned automatically with no manual routing	Fulfillment teams work from one consistent task list		Requesters receive proactive status updates		Asset records stay accurate with no manual data entry	Dashboards give leadership real-time visibility		
Negative moments What steps does a typical person find frustrating, confusing, angering, costly, or time-consuming?	Requesters are unsure which laptop they are allowed to order		Too many catalog categories make the right item hard to find				Long forms lead to missing or incorrect information			Manual order handling caused delays and rework before automation	Approvals stall when managers are unavailable or out of office	Tasks can reach the wrong group if flow conditions are set up incorrectly	Vendor stock-outs and shipping delays are hard to predict			Survey response rates are low			Flow failures can go unnoticed without error alerts	
Areas of opportunity How might we make each step better? What ideas do we have? What have others suggested?			Recommend a laptop by role or department Add search filters for standard models	Provide a simple side-by-side comparison of approved models			Pre-fill requester details from the user profile Use catalog variables and UI policies to cut required fields		Include an estimated delivery date in the confirmation email		How might we auto-approve every request under the budget threshold? Add reminders and delegate approvers for stalled approvals	Add error handling and notifications for failed flow actions	Integrate with the vendor API for real-time stock and order status		Add a setup guide link to the delivery notification	Send a one-click rating in the email to raise response rates		Build a dashboard of cycle time and cost savings	Use flow execution history to fix bottlenecks	Reuse the flow as a template for monitors, phones, and accessories